



City Parks
CONSERVANCY

Passport Program
Implementation Plan Draft
Little Rock City Parks

Little Rock City Parks Passport Program



Implementation Plan

Project Overview:

The Little Rock Parks Passport Program is a citywide initiative encouraging residents and visitors to explore the full network of parks across the city. The program is facilitated by a partnership between the City of Little Rock Department of Parks & Recreation and the City Parks Conservancy a 501 c3 Non profit.

The initiative will create a fun and engaging way for residents to explore the expansive Little Rock Parks system as well as the programs and services that the Little Rock Parks and Recreation department oversees, with the goal to help foster an understanding and appreciation of the vast parks system available in Little Rock. The system is modeled after various municipal and statewide parks passport programs, specifically the Arkansas State Parks system passport program.

The Passport program will provide participants with a physical "passport" booklet that visitors can use to log their visits to various participating Little Rock parks and other properties maintained by the department at designated passport stations. Participants will document their visit in the passport booklet by taking a pencil rubbing of a site-specific metal medallion that will be located at each designated passport station. Participants who visit all the designated passport locations and document their visit in the passport booklet will be able to choose from various prizes provided by the parks department. In addition, any visitor that complete the passport program will learn more about Little Rock's outdoor spaces, history, and recreational opportunities all while exploring parts of their own city they may not have otherwise discovered.

Program Goals:

- Grow awareness for the large number of parks and properties operated and maintained by Little Rock Parks & Recreation.
- Grow awareness of the variety of different programs, services and events offered by Little Rock Parks & Recreation.
- Build citizen support for Little Rock Parks and Recreation.
- Promote healthy outdoor recreation.
- Encourage residents to explore parks in different neighborhoods.

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Program Components: The program will consist of 3 main components

1. The Passport Booklet
2. The Passport Stations
3. The Program Management

- **Passport Booklet**

- The passport will be a physical booklet roughly 5 x 7 or 3 x 5 and will include information about the passport program. It will also contain pages designated for each participating location with a brief description or fun fact about each location along with a designated box for participants to stamp. A line will be included for each stamp to record the date of each visit if the participant desires to do so.
- The passport will also contain multiple pages for future participating locations with a blank space for the stamp and a line to record the name of the location. This will allow for participating locations to be phased in over time without needing to reprint a new booklet whenever new locations are made available.
 - **OPTION:** If the program is implemented before the end of 2026, an additional page can be included in the booklet with information about the CPC and its 25th anniversary as well as the current "30 for 30" campaign
- The passport will be paper document but will need to be durable enough to endure some wear and tear.
- The passport will include a QR code that will connect to a website for the program that will also provide information about the program as well as a map to the various park locations. (See Program Management)
- Once completed, the passport document can be hand delivered to the LR Parks and Recreation department in City Hall,
 - **OPTION:** The passport document can also have the mailing address for LRPR listed in the center of the backside of the document, along with a space for a stamp and returned address, if participants choose to mail their completed passport in, rather than hand deliver it to City Hall.

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▪ Passport Stations

- Designated passport stations will be located at each participating park or other parks maintained location, either in an easily accessed location near the park entrance or possibly at a significant location within the park, such as a landmark, vista or significant feature. The specific location of the passport station in each park will be noted on the online map (See Program Management)
- The Passport stations will be a simplistic design and will be the same at all locations. The design will be a simple post with a embossed metal rubbing plate.
 - The post will either be a treated 4 x 4 wood post set directly into the ground with concrete, or a steel tube with a base plate, attached to a concrete base.
 - "Passport Station" will be written on each post along with a QR code that will link to the program website (See Program Management)
 - The top of the post will be cut at a 60 degree angle and will be capped with a cast bronze or cast aluminum cover that will be permanently attached to the post, either by welding or adhesive, to prevent theft.
 - The cap will have an embossed passport emblem. Participants will place the page of their passport with the correlating park over the medallion in the designated space on the page, and take a pencil rubbing of the medallion to "stamp" their passport. Each medallion will be similar in design but will have the name of the specific park where it is located.
- OPTION – The passport stations could also include a spot for additional signage if an entity wishes to sponsor the installation of a passport station and contribute to the program funding for upkeep. However any sponsorship signage should be kept to a minimum and not overpower with the simplistic design of the station itself.

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▪ Program Management

- The Passport program will be administered by LRPR. A department staff, possibly the volunteer coordinator, will be designated to be responsible for the program. Responsibilities include:
 - Receiving completed passports
 - Signing completed passports in the designated signature location.
 - Awarding prizes to participants
 - Logging info into the passport program record keeping digital document, including:
 - Participant Info. (Name, Age, Address, Email, etc...)
 - Completed passport information. (Date of verification, signature and name of verifier.)
 - Date of Passport completion.
 - Number of stamps collected
 - What prize was awarded.
 - Maintaining and updating the digital record keeping document.
 - Coordinating Prize certificates with related department personnel
 - Coordinating with LRPR facilities staff on the upkeep of passport stations.
 - Coordinating with LRPR IT for updates to the associated program website.
 - Coordinating with LRPR Marketing on social media posts and announcements.
 - Coordination of new passport station implementation
 - Providing updates to LRPR Admin, the LR Parks Commission and the CPC on the program.
- Passports can be obtained from the LRPR at either city hall or at any of the staffed facilities operated by LRPR (ie, Community Centers, Jim Dailey Fitness Center, Ottenheimer Therapeutic Recreation Center, Rebsamen Tennis Center, MacArthur Museum of Arkansas Military History, Rebsamen and First Tee Golf courses etc...) Participants can also obtain a passport from the CPC during organized events or during events that the CPC is participating in. The booklets are free.
- LRPR will maintain a webpage on it's existing website dedicated to the Passport Program. The website will provide information about the program, such as where to obtain a passport and what to do once a passport is completed, and will also have a map of all participating locations, showing the location of each passport station at each park and a status for the station (Active, Under Repiars, In Progress, Not Yet Active...) The Website will also list the prize options.

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How the Program works:

- To begin, participants must acquire a passport booklet. The passports can be obtained for free at anytime during normal business hours from LR City Hall at the front desk of the LRPR department, as well as during any regular business hours from any other participating LRPR facilities or community center. The CPC will also keep a supply of passports on hand to distribute at any CPC organized events or any other events that the CPC participates in.
- Once a participant acquires an official Passport booklet, they may begin collecting stamps from participating locations.
- A participant can use the information provided on the associated website online to find participating parks and the specific location of the passport station at each location, or simply use the passport booklet to start traveling to the locations listed in the document and hunt for the passport stations themselves.
- Once a participant finds a passport station, they will look in the passport booklet, find that associated page for that passport station location, place the page over the cast medallion cap of the passport station, align the emblem with the designated stamp area on the blank page, and use a pencil to take a rubbing of the emblem. Participants can record the date of their stamp if desired, but it is not mandatory.
- If a participant visits a passport station, but does not have their passport document with them, they may use another piece of paper to take a rubbing. They can then attach the rubbing to their passport in the designated stamp location with either glue, tape or staples. However to complete the passport document, all stamps must be attached to the passport. Participants can not turn in loose pages of collected rubbings.
 - OPTION: Some other passport programs offer prizes at program milestones. If desired, the program could offer small intermediate prizes to participants once certain milestones are hit, such as 25 parks documented. Prize could include program branded clothing items such as at-shirt or hat, or a program sticker.
- Once all participating locations have been documented in the passport, participants may submit their passport to LRPR for verification. Participants can present their completed passport to the LRPR department by arriving to City Hall and delivering their document to the LRPR front desk.

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- Once the document is received, the designated LRPR program staff will review the passport to ensure all the locations have been recorded. After the document is verified, the staff person will sign the passport in the designated location and record the participants' info to be documented in the program management software.
- The staff person will then present the prize options to the participant to select from. Once the participant selects their prize, the staff person will present the participant with a form of a certificate (currently undetermined) of the prize and record the selected prize in the program management software.
- The staff person will then return the signed passport document to the participant as a memento of their participation.
 - OPTION: Participants may also choose to place a stamp on the back of the passport document and mail it in to be verified. However the participant must designate on the document the prize they wish to receive, as selected from the online options. The participant must understand if they wish to keep their passport, they must collect it at the LRPR offices, as it will not be mailed back to them.

Prizes:

- A variety of prize options would be available to participants to choose from. The prizes would all be services provided by LRPR to further promote the variety of services the department provides to Little Rock residents. LRPR would need to determine a method for Prize distribution, if there is not already a way to provide gift certificates for services. Ideas for prizes could include:
 - Free 1-year membership to Jim Dailey Fitness Center
 - Free Season Pass to Rebsamen Tennis Center
 - Free round of golf at Rebsamen or First Tee
 - Free entry to LR Marathon or other LR Parks Event
 - Free Pavillion Rental
 - Free Youth Program Registration
 - Free Adult League Sports Registration
 - Free Museum Entry to MacArthur Park Museums
 - Free 1-year membership to the LR Zoo
 - Possible Other Partnerships
 - Free bike or Kayak rental from Rock Town River Outfitters?
 - Discount at Ozark Outdoors?
 - Discount at Perk & Recreation?
 - Free entry for BDB 100?

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Responsibilities:

Responsibilities for ongoing management of the program would rely mostly on LRPR staff as well as the fabrication, installation and maintenance of the passport stations. However, the CPC would take on the responsibility for designing and printing the passport booklet, as well as the advertising and promotion of the passport program. In addition, the data collected by LRPR from participants could be shared to help the CPC to connect with possible supporters and future donors for LRPR through the CPC.

- CPC Responsibilities
 - Booklet Design
 - Booklet Printing
 - Program Promotion
- LRPR Responsibilities
 - Medallion Design
 - Passport Station (Medallion and Signpost) Fabrication and Installation
 - Passport Station Ongoing Maintenance
 - Website Design & Management
 - Receiving, verifying and recording completed passports
 - Prize Distribution Method, Coordination and Documenting
 - Program Management & Tracking
- Shared Tasks
 - Passport Distribution

Fabrication & Development:

- Book Printing
- Medallion Fabrication
- Sign Fabrication
- Website Development
- Program Management Software Development

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Locations (70 Total):

<u>Park Key:</u>	City Park	Undeveloped Park	Community Center	Trail	Golf Course	Other
• Alexander		• Interstate				• Richland
• Allsopp		• Jonesboro				• Riverfront
• Arkansas River Trail		• Junior Deputy?				▪ Sculpture at the River Market
• Bell Pointe		• Kanis				• River Mountain
• Benny Craig		• Kingwood				• Rock Creek Trail
• Birchwood		• Kiwanis				• Rose Creek
• Boyle		• Knoop				• Section 13
• Brodie Creek		• MacArthur				• Southwest Community center
• Butler		▪ MacArthur Museum of Arkansas Military History				• Stephens Community Center
• Candlewood Park		• Meriwether				• Southside
• Centennial		• Morehart				• Taylor Loop
• Cheatham		• Murray				• Terry Park
• Conner		• Natural Steps				• Thom
• Crump		• Ninth Street				• Two Rivers
• Curran Conway		• Oak Forest				• Union
• Dunbar Community Center		• Ottenheimer				• The Centre at University Park
• East little Rock Community Center		▪ Ottenheimer Therapeutic Recreation Center				▪ Rebsamen Tennis Center
• First Tee Golf Course		• Otter Creek				• Wakefield
• Fletcher		• Pankey				• War Memorial
• Fouche Bottoms		• Pettaway				▪ Jim Dailey Fitness & Aquatic Center
• Fouche Creek		• Pinedale Cove				• Weedman Park
• Gillam		• Prospect Terrace				• West Central Community center & Sports Complex
• Granite Heights		• Rebsamen Golf Course				• Western Hills
• Hanger Hill		• R Emmel				• Zoo
• Hillside		• Reservoir				
• Hindman						

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Phased Passport Station Installment Plan

Year 1 (44 Stations)

- | | | |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------|--|
| • Allsopp | • Gillam | • Rebsamen Golf Course |
| • Benny Craig | • Granite Heights | • Rammel |
| • Birchwood | • Hanger Hill | • Reservoir |
| • Boyle | • Hindman | • Richland |
| • Brodie Creek | • Interstate | • River Mountain |
| • Butler | • Kanis | • Southwest Community center |
| • Centennial | • Kiwanis | • Stephens Community Center |
| • Cheatham | • Knoop | • Southside |
| • Conner | • MacArthur | • Two Rivers |
| • Crump | • Meriwether | • Union |
| • Curran Conway | • Morehart | • War Memorial |
| • Dunbar Community Center | • Murray | • West Central Community center & Sports Complex |
| • East little Rock Community Center | • Ottenheimer | • Western Hills |
| • Fletcher | • Otter Creek | |
| • Fouche Creek | • Pankey | |
| | • Pettaway | |

Year 2: (10 Stations)

- | | | |
|---|---------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| • Arkansas River Trail | • Sculpture at the River Market | • The Centre at University Park |
| • Ninth Street | • Rose Creek | • Wakefield |
| • Ottenheimer Therapeutic Recreation Center | • Thom | • Zoo |
| • Prospect Terrace | | |

Year 3: (10 Stations)

- | | | |
|---|--------------------|---------------------------------------|
| • First Tee Golf Course | • Natural Steps | • Section 13 |
| • Jonesboro | • Oak Forest | • Rebsamen Tennis Center |
| • MacArthur Museum of Arkansas Military History | • Pinedale Cove | • Jim Dailey Fitness & Aquatic Center |
| | • Rock Creek Trail | |

Year 4: (10 Stations)

- | | | |
|-------------------|-----------------|----------------|
| • Alexander | • Hillside | • Terry Park |
| • Bell Pointe | • Junior Deputy | • Weedman Park |
| • Candlewood Park | • Kingwood | |
| • Fouche Bottoms | • Taylor Loop | |

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Project Budget

Passport Booklet:

- Booklet Design \$0
- Booklet Printing \$1,500

Passport Station:

- Emblem Design \$0
- Emblem Fabrication: (2" Dia. Qty: 140, 2 ea)
 - Option A– Etched Stainless Steel Plaques w/ Recessed Text \$25,000
 - Option B–Die Cast (\$13,300)
 - Does not include taxes or installation
- Station: Materials & installation (Qty: 70 Total)
 - Materials \$4,000
 - 3 ft 4x4 Treated Wood Post
 - 18" Deep, 8" Diameter, Cone Base (Quickcrete Tube)
 - Simpson Tie Post Base
 - Galvanized Metal Post Cap
 - 3" x 3" Square Acrylic Signage
 - Installation \$6,200
 - 2 installers
 - 2 hours each post

Total Estimated Cost **\$36,700**

Additional Items:

- Program Tracking Software Design ???
- Website Design ???